

February 17, 2025

Milestone 1: Team Formation, Software Theme, &
Entrepreneurial Context Report and Presentation

I. Introduction:

The purpose of our product, Real Productivity Game, is to introduce a gamification of real life interactions into a software that provides instant gratification. This is to motivate and challenge people who may need a small dopamine hit in their daily lives. Those who have low motivation or want to find a new “brand-new” style of having a social interaction with their friends opt to find many ways to do so without taking too much time to interact. Gamification has been shown to change user behavior from passive to active, making them happy to interact with the gamified system and engage with other users (D. Zhao, 2022). The same factors that make video games engaging seem to also be motivating people online in non-video game settings (S. Deterding, 2011). Our game’s purpose is to provide an outlet for users to visually demonstrate their consistent achievement of small, everyday goals. These goals build up a story of progress where our in-game reward system then displays those achievements. Our aim is to solve the problem of users struggling with motivation, finding the drive to accomplish goals, and management of time. This would help alleviate those by providing interests in chores and mundane tasks into something that is visibly rewarding. Our social aspect of working with people around you to achieve a communal goal may also be a way to increase productivity and provide a healthy lifestyle.

II. Team Formation:

Team RPG Dev was ultimately formed at California State University of Long Beach during Spring 2025 of a CECS 491A class as a team of six individuals. Our Team Leader, Bryan

Tran, brings his experience of already being introduced to working in multiple teams from his current internship. He has experience with C++, Python, SQL, API usage, setting up small servers, and will mainly work on backend, testing, quality assurance, and of course guiding the team through our goal of creating a productivity application. Through his internship, he also has learned how to create requirements and documentation standards that may prove useful during our year-long project. Our UX/UI and Front End Specialist is Brady Askins. Brady is also well-versed with C++ and provides a familiarity with Unity with the goal to learn more front end development such as CSS and creating user interfaces with this project. The Quality Assurance role falls to Mitchell Flanagan, who's skilled in C++ and Python and ensures clarity and accuracy in documentation. Mitchell will lead in creating templates for documents such as our requirements and making sure our game application accurately reflects those requirements, so it could help us easier in transitioning with updates and features. Our next team member is Jordan Ramos who is skilled in C++, Java, C#, and web development with frameworks. His main role in our team is taking on the role as a User Researcher. Jordan has past experience with doing research and will help guide the team in designing the visual aspect of our application by his own experiences and finding patterns that existing modern games currently have. Michael Pham-Tran has experience in C++, Java, Python, and Haskell, specifically in object-oriented programming. His role is a Back End Developer and is also interested in learning more about web development. Michael also has experience in web scraping and writing simple scripts and will also help the team in writing test scripts. Joining Brady Askins in the UX/UI department is Erick Mao who has experience with using C++, Python, and SQL. He is currently working, developing, and improving skills in user interface design, and mobile app design. A few of our members are already friends from previous classes. However, this will be our first time working with each

other on a larger scale project. Our team members are unique with different goals and bring a diverse skill set that will help the team to develop our product to be a comprehensive solution for users that engage with it. Most importantly we all have common experience in the theme of our team's product: gaming. Team RPG Dev's mission is to develop a product that engages users interaction while encouraging healthy and productive habits. There are challenges that we are sure to face, but as long as we acknowledge them, there are strategies to manage potential conflicts or issues that we can preemptively come up with to circumvent these challenges to ensure a smooth development. How do we make a game engaging enough to keep users medium or long term? Adding social mechanics to our applications would add a low-stake competition between users. Another hurdle includes the trust system that players may deviate from. This would be a potential issue that we must solve during our progression of creating this application.

III. Software Theme:

Our game's intended audience are for unmotivated students and for workplace organizations to use as a way to keep track of daily goals and tasks without intruding in their busy lives. Self-Determination Theory (SDT) assumes that "people are active organisms, naturally striving for psychological growth and development" (Ryan & Deci, 2000). We want our application to reach individuals who are struggling to find that natural push for mental growth and development. This includes those that have attention deficiencies or simply struggle with gaining motivation to accomplish goals. A big theme surrounding our project is managing tasks by providing an easy-to-use application that has features unlocking over time so users won't be overwhelmed easily. There will always be a way to play "catch-up" to everyone else as long as their consistency stays true. Our interactive application tracks user's inputted activities and goals and has the ability to connect with existing hardware such as smart devices to easily load data

into the application. Some basic smart applications we intend to integrate into our application include smart scales and smart watches. Our game will include social aspects such as leaderboards and in-game guilds and parties that will provide a way for friends to team up and attack goals together. There will be an RPG-like game application that has a leveling and reward system along with an optional subscription add-on. This application is meant to be low maintenance and not a lot of effort from the user is needed to set up their game as aspects of the game would slowly unlock as they play longer and progress, which is a reflection of their real-life productivity. This game is originally built on the trust of the user regarding their intentions, goals, and tasks.

IV. Entrepreneurial Context:

We do believe that there is a market gap for our product to fit into, and that there will be a market for our product to succeed in. The market that our application would look to fall under is the gamification market. Based on a Market Research Report the gamification market size in 2024 was \$22.01 billion and is expected to grow to \$27.11 billion in 2025(yahoo! finance, 2025). We have looked at our competitors in our potential market, and what makes our product unique is that we focus on a different set of clients. Some of the key competitors that are involved with the gamification market are Microsoft and Google. Most gamify apps that help with productivity are either workout focused apps or ones that do basic chores. What makes our app different from the rest is that we do not just focus on one thing, we want our app to be versatile. Our main market would be college students and those in the workforce. We want our app to have a social aspect that no other goal tracking app has. Our app also has a reward system to keep users on track and not fall off their streak of productivity. We also integrate our app with workplace environments to give workers rewards through their company using our point tracking system.

And for those using our app independently, we have many unique ways of keeping you on track to complete your lofty goals with instant gratification and rewards to get cosmetics and customizations. Our monetization strategy is to have a free initial cost so that anyone who is in need of productivity help seeks out our product. After using our product, we would offer them incentives to help keep them on track and become more efficient through a paid subscription service like a seasonal battle pass or paid themes to customize your experience more to your liking.

V. Conclusion:

People like video games, A lot. Many people also struggle with productivity. These two demographics are not mutually exclusive. The process of gamification is also not a new concept. It has been shown to motivate users compared to their non-gamified contexts. Life can be mundane at times (more often than not) for people and so a product like RPG can help push them in a better direction to stimulate their everyday lives while simultaneously giving them rewards. We believe we have built a team with a diverse background and strong set of skills that will allow us to develop RPG throughout Spring and Fall 2025. We want our project to be able to help those who seek to improve their everyday productivity in everyday life as well as in the workplace. We will have a free initial buy-in for those wanting help in improving their productivity, and a paid subscription service for those wanting more customization and incentives to improve.

References

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